



**Primary school and the application of total quality standards
Reality and obstacles
(A field study on a sample of schools in Saida City)**

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Abstract ;

This study aimed to identify the reality of applying quality standards in primary schools in viewpoint Of primary schools director and to identify the obstacles that prevent their application. The study sample consisted of 60 principals who were selected intentionally. The study used a descriptive analytical approach and a questionnaire to collect data. After statistical processing of the data using statistical packages for social studies (SPSS), the study reached the following conclusions: The application of comprehensive quality standards in primary schools was moderate from the perspective of the principals. and there were no statistically significant differences at the(0.05) level between the averages of principals' responses regarding the extent of the application of comprehensive quality standards in primary schools attributable to the gender variable, while the study indicated the existence of statistically significant differences at the(0.05) level attributed to years of experience in favour of those with less than 5 years of experience. The most prominent obstacles limiting the application of total quality standards in administrative work were the lack of material resources, raw materials and financial resources necessary to apply total quality standards at the primary school level, the absence of training courses for primary school principals on how to apply quality standards, and the lack of sufficient knowledge among primary school principals about the principles and standards of total quality management. Based on the findings, the study made a number of recommendations, including providing training programmes for principals, ensuring that officials focus on strategic planning rather than traditional planning, and providing a comfortable learning environment in schools to increase employee performance.

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1. Introduction

School administration is a cornerstone of the educational process because of its important and effective role in the success of the entire educational process, and the desired educational objectives cannot be achieved without an effective school administration capable of drawing and implementing educational plans, as the function of school administration has extended to include the administrative and educational aspects, as the school principal has become responsible for all administrative work and technical aspects, including curricula, textbooks, training methods, relations with the community and other schools, securing financial resources, developing work, following up all school, cultural, social and sports activities, and planning.

Total quality management in the educational field means the performance of work in a correct and perfect manner according to a set of educational standards necessary to raise the level of quality of the educational product with the least effort and cost, achieving the educational educational objectives, society's goals and meeting the needs of the labour market for scientifically qualified cadres. Quality standards in education refer to those characteristics and conditions that must be met in the educational system, including the objectives and methods of teaching, the evaluation and examination system, teacher quality, buildings and material equipment to ensure that graduates have the basic knowledge that qualifies them to compete in all fields.

Spreading the organisational culture of total quality and its philosophy in the

primary stage by changing the prevailing values and behaviour and changing the administrative pattern to participatory management will be the key and natural entry point to improve and raise the quality of the educational process in all its stages to achieve the desired educational goals. (Al-Banna, 2006).

2. Problematic study:

It has had many factors that have had an impact on the attention to overall quality in the education sector, the most prominent of which are: The Economic Changes Accompanying the Scientific and Technological Explosion and the Expansion of Education and its Increasing Demand at All Levels of Education including University and Higher Education In addition to the new social pressures posed by the conditions of the times of increasing the means of communication in quantity and quality, the explosion of knowledge and the work of women and others, These pressures have placed increasing responsibilities on educational institutions. In addition to these factors, the academic and scientific desire to develop new knowledge about the various tributaries of life and to promote private and public quality processes. Researchers have been interested in theoretical and applied aspects of total quality management in these institutions (Zidan, 2010, p. 24), considered Hariri (2016)

Total Quality Management (TQM) improves leadership and management styles and works to introduce appropriate and new changes and involve all members of the school in bringing about that change collectively and cooperatively so as to ensure continuous modernization and development while fostering a spirit of fair

competition between schools to address the challenges of the times and successive developments.

One of the studies that dealt with the application of total quality management standards in the management of schools is the study of Rami (2018) which aimed to recognize the degree of application of the principles of total quality management in government basic schools in the city of Aqaba in Jordan from the perspective of teachers. The different perspectives according to the variables of gender, specialization, qualification and years of experience, where the results indicated that the degree of application of the principles of total quality management in government basic schools in the city of Aqaba in Jordan from the point of view of teachers was average. The lack of teacher response to the implementation of TQM principles in public basic schools in Aqaba, Jordan, as discussed by Sharqawi. (2002) In the reality of total quality management in secondary schools in Egypt, and the presentation of a proposed concept to improve quality management, the study found no interest in training the management team on modern administrative entrances such as the entrance to total quality management, and the director of the school needs to follow the entrance to total quality management as Refai and Badran (2002) His study was concerned with defining the concept of total quality and methods of measuring it, shedding light on the modern inspection system and its most important functions. Consequently, the development of a proposed strategy for educational inspection and quality control in general education schools, The study found that

Egyptian education suffers from a crisis of inadequate education inputs and low educational quality. While Mansour's study (2005) aimed at developing a proposed concept for employing the principles of total quality management in secondary schools in Gaza governorates, the study found a lack of awareness of the philosophy of total quality management and a lack of reliance on statistical methods in the management decision-making process. And attention to the process of continuous improvement, in addition to the non-use of total quality management tools, In order to identify the main obstacles that may face the implementation of total quality management, Saudi Arabia (2003) conducted a study by which he pointed out the most important of these obstacles, namely the permanent change of senior management leaders, the lack of conviction of some senior management leaders in training, the rigidity of laws and regulations, their inflexibility, the difficulty of measuring and evaluating the results of work accurately and the weakness of material capabilities, while Derbas (1994) noted To a number of obstacles to the possibility of applying total quality management to the educational sector, the most prominent of which is the weakness of information rules and systems in the educational sector, and the lack of qualified training staff in addition to centralization in the formulation of policies and decision-making, while the study of fedgouch (2018) The degree of application of total quality management in school administration from the perspective of teachers. The study found that the degree of application of total quality management in school administration in general was

average in the following areas: Organization, planning, pupil affairs and needs, evaluation, planning, Hammouda's study (2008) also aimed to measure the extent to which total quality management is applied in private secondary schools from the perspective of managers. The results showed that total quality management is highly applied in all fields in private secondary schools. And also the lack of differences in the variable sex and experience and scientific qualification in the degree of application of total quality management in high schools, and researched the study Al-Madawi (2012). In the obstacles to the application of total quality in the school administration in secondary education, the study found no differences between the responses of the sample members on the obstacles to the application of total quality in the school management in secondary according to the variables of the study (gender, experience, scientific qualification), Daifallah (2017) researched through her study to identify the impact of the use of information and communication technology on improving the quality of the educational process and found that the use of information and communication technology has a significant impact on improving the quality of the educational process in various components. Therefore, it can be said that quality in education means the ability of the educational institution to provide a service of a high level of outstanding quality. Through it, you can keep abreast of developments on the cognitive and technological level and this leads us to question the reality of the application of total quality standards in primary school

from the perspective of managers by asking the following questions:

- What is the degree to which total quality standards are applied in primary schools?
- Are there statistically significant differences from primary school principals' view of the reality of applying quality standards in school administration attributable to the gender variable?
- Are there statistically significant differences from the primary school principals' view of the reality of applying quality standards in school administration attributable to the variable years of experience?
- what are the obstacles to implementing the Total Quality Standards in primary schools from point of view of school principals ?

3. Study hypotheses:

- Total quality standards are applied in primary schools to a high degree.
- Statistically significant differences exist from the perspective of primary school principals in the reality of the application of quality standards in school administration attributed to the gender variable.
- There are statistically significant differences from the primary school principals' view of the reality of applying quality standards in school management attributed to the variable years of experience.
- There are the obstacles to implementing the Total Quality Standards in primary schools from point of view of school principals

4. Study objectives:

The study objectives can be defined as knowing the degree of application of total quality management in school administration in different fields (planning,

organization, guidance, evaluation), as well as identifying the differences between primary school principals in determining the extent of application of total quality management in school administration according to the gender variable and years of experience by identifying the most prominent obstacles facing principals in applying total quality standards from their point of view, by presenting a set of recommendations to raise awareness among those concerned about the obstacles they face

5. The importance of study:

The importance of the study is that it tries to identify the need of educational institutions, specifically primary schools, to apply quality standards due to poor outcomes, as well as to provide educational and school leaders with the principles on which total quality management is based in order to encourage the application of the philosophy of total quality in school life to improve the level of teachers in scientific and behavioral aspects because quality is described as comprehensive.

6. Defining concepts:

6.1. Reality:

It is defined as that which can be measured, which cannot be distinguished from nothingness except through measurement, and which is the present moment.

6.2. Obstacles :

Obstacles in the current study are defined as barriers or difficulties that limit the application of quality standards, based on the responses of the sample individuals to the questionnaire items.

6.3. Standards : The concept of standards means a set of standards and rules governing the doing of things, which are the general lines referred to by decision-

makers and workers in institutions and companies of different subject matter.

Procedurally defined as a number of cognitive and performance requirements that elementary school principals must have while working in school.

6.4. Total Quality: Is a set of features that must be available in all elements of the institution of inputs, processes and outputs to achieve the needs of workers and their wishes and requirements within the institution and the local community (Issa, 2001, p. 38)

It is known procedurally as a new direction in the style of administrative management by creating a new organizational culture based on radical changes between administrative processes, such as planning, organization, guidance, and control properly, so that the school can finally achieve the goals of education and the educational process.

6.5. Primary School: It is the first and basic stage that students enter to receive their education, in which they begin to learn the correct literacy principles, a cumulative and constructive process, which will affect them at the advanced stages in the educational process.

It is defined procedurally: It is a place or location where pupils are taught and provided with information and knowledge and taught experiences and this educational institution consists of teachers, pupils and the director.

1. Total Quality Management:

A. ISO definition: "Is a management approach to an organization or company, focused on quality and based on the contribution of all members, and aimed at long-term success, through customer satisfaction and benefit all members of the

organization and society as well."(Saouas, 1999, p. 4)

B. Definition of total quality management in education:

- "All the efforts exerted by educational workers to raise the level of the educational product (student) commensurate with the requirements of society, and the application of a set of educational and pedagogical standards and specifications necessary to raise the level of the educational product through the concerted efforts of all workers in the field of education") Rochdi, 2006, p. 26)

- A method of administrative practice requires a major transformation in the management of the inputs of the institution to the educational process in order to reach the continuous improvement of outputs and services provided by them to ensure the satisfaction of the beneficiaries of the educational and learning process (Mohammed, 2010, p. 33)

2. Justification for applying TQM:

The application of TQM in education has become a top concern today, due to several justifications cited by Said (1998, p. 46) Quality is linked to productivity and inclusiveness in all fields, in addition to the success of the implementation of the total quality system in many institutions in most countries of the world according to the philosophy and cultural and social factors surrounding them and based on methodologies and mechanisms appropriate to their economic, social and political conditions.

3. The importance of applying total quality in education:

Many of the challenges and issues facing the educational process imposed the need to have a new direction that corresponds to

and deals with these challenges in a way that achieves development in the outcomes of the educational process The majority of countries have focused on achieving the total quality approach in education, and this comes from the importance of total quality and the resulting positive aspects that serve the educational process. It greatly helps the transformation of educational thought for the better through continuous improvement and development not only of the educational process, but also of the administrative aspect (Badi, 2011, p. 33).

4. Reasons for applying the total quality system in schools:

The implementation of TQMS in schools is an urgent necessity at present for many reasons mentioned by kamel (2002, p. 602) The graduate should be able to absorb the rapid technological development, and the graduate should be specialized and skilled in his work and have the ability to creativity and innovation in order to keep pace with the economic changes accompanying the new world order, and the expansion of education and increase demand for it, while total quality management is an appropriate framework for coordinating and unifying all development efforts, because it offers many advantages according to madani (2002, p. 2) The TQM calls for continuous improvement, which is the primary objective of the development processes, and TQM focuses on performance measurement and evaluation which is one of the objectives of the current development procedures.

5. Requirements for ensuring total quality in educational institutions:

- Institutional capacity: Focuses on the general specifications of the institution that

reflect its ability to carry out its functions. It describes - in specific terms - how to infer the capacity of the educational institution through a sufficient number of items, including strategic planning, organizational structure, leadership and governance, credibility and ethics and administrative apparatus, financial and material resources, community participation and environmental development, and institutional evaluation. (Kacem, 2008, p. 12)

Strategic planning: An activity undertaken by an organization for the purpose of reaching a long-term plan (at least five years).

Organizational structure: The organizational structure of the institution includes the administrative components of the institution and their relationship to each other.

Leadership and governance: Leadership is the ability to motivate employees to face difficulties and solve problems to achieve goals and reach a common vision.

D - Credibility and ethics: Its availability in all elements and work procedures within institutions of higher education

E. Administrative machinery: Constitutes the main basis for fulfilling roles and achieving objectives

F - Financial and material resources: Is the main supporter of the institution in achieving its activities, and support its efforts to develop its functions.

G. Community participation and environmental development: Contributes to community development.

6. Obstacles to the Application of Total Quality Management in Education:

Obstacles to Quality Management in Education pointed out by Fedghouch (2018,

p. 19) To a number of obstacles such as the instability of the department and its permanent change in the sense of the succession of managers on the same school does not allow them to understand and apply their interests that differ from those of the previous or subsequent director. A focus on performance appraisal, not conscious leadership that helps individuals achieve higher quality and thus management turns to intimidating management. The weakness of the school's information system, the scarcity of accurate and rapid data and information on the educational system and its management due to the lack of effective information systems between the reliance on traditional methods of collecting information and data on school management and its development are among the most prominent obstacles to the application of quality in education, as well as the inadequacy of curricula and teaching methods: These curricula are characterized by deficiencies in their content and methods of evaluation, lack of educational means and adoption of teaching methods based on memorization and indoctrination (Djad, 2008, p. 10)

7. Methodological procedures of the study

7.1. Curriculum : Since the current study is intended to explore the views of primary school principals on the reality and obstacles of applying quality standards in school management, the descriptive curriculum is the appropriate curriculum for this study, as it was used to investigate the views of primary school principals in a happy state on the obstacles of applying total quality standards in management.

7.2. Sample Study : The study sample consisted of 60 headteachers from primary

schools in the city of Saida, who were selected deliberately, as deliberate samples are those chosen by researchers based on their experience. This type of sample is useful when the community is small or specialised, or when time and resources are limited, in addition to the responsiveness of these school principals to the study procedures and the ease of providing information to the researcher. Distributed according to the characteristics shown in Table 1.

Table 1. Distribution of study sample members by variables

Variables	Categories	Number	Percentage
type	Male	40	% 66.66
	Female	20	% 33.34
	Total	60	%100
Years of experience	0-10 years	30	% 50
	years and over	30	% 50
	Total	60	%100

Source: output spss

The table shows that the proportion of males was 66.66% of the study sample, while the proportion of females was estimated at 33.34%. The variable years of experience were equal to 50% for primary school principals, whether new or those with long experience in administrative management.

7.3. Study Tools : The researcher designed a questionnaire as a tool for the study with reference to previous studies, where the questionnaire included two axes

-The first axis:Addresses planning and implementation number of phrases 12

-The second axis: Dealing with management, guidance and evaluation number of phrases 10

7.3.1.Tool fiabilité and stability :The internal consistency of the tool was ascertained by calculating the Pearson correlation coefficient between the grades of each of the questionnaire phrases and the total grade, as shown in table 2.

Table 2. shows the Pearson correlation coefficients to measure the relationship of a phrase's score to its overall score.

Axis 1		Axis 2	
phrase Number	Correlation Factor	phrase Number	Correlation Factor
1	**0.88	13	*0.58
2	**0.77	14	*0.55
3	0.68	15	**0.86
4	**0.70	16	**0.81
5	*0.61	17	*0.66
6	**0.78	18	*0.53
7	**0.71	19	*0.45
8	*0.60	20	*0.49
9	*0.59	21	**0.73
10	*0.62	22	**0.84
11	**0.74		
12	*0.50		

* Statistical Signification at 0.01

** Statistical Signification at 0.05

Source: output spss

The table shows that the Pearson correlation coefficients between all phrases and the questionnaire as a whole function at the denominator 0.01 and 0.05, which shows that the scale has a high degree of fiability

The stability of the instrument was confirmed using Cronbach's Alpha, which gave the values shown in Table 3.

Table 3. Stability Factors for Study Tool and Fields

Number	Field	Number of phrases	Cronbach coefficient alpha
1	Planning & Implementation	12	0.81
2	Administration, guidance and Evaluation	10	0.77
Total grade		22	0.79

Source: output spss

Table 3 shows that the stability of the questionnaire areas ranged from 0.77-0.81 to 0.79, making it viable for research purposes.

The gradient scale was used as a criterion for judging the questionnaire (high, medium, low), and values from 3 to 1 were

assigned to each option, as shown in Table 4.

Table 4: Likert scale

Réponse	Low	Medium	High
Degree	3	2	1

Table 5: Corrective values for the study tool

Descriptive values	Degree of correction
Low	To 1 - 1.66
Medium	To 1.67 - 2.33
High	To 3 - 2.34

7.4.1. Statistical processing : The data were then processed statistically using the Social Sciences Statistical Package (SPSS22) software, and from statistical processors used, iterations, arithmetic averages, standard deviations. Test "T" for two independent samples. (Independent t-test)

8. View and discuss search results

8.1. Presentation and discussion of the results of the first hypothesis: The text "Total quality standards are applied in primary schools to a high degree"

To answer the hypothesis, the arithmetic averages and standard deviations of the responses of the sample members were calculated on the paragraphs of the questionnaire as shown in Table 4.

Table 6 . Arithmetic averages and standard deviations of sample responses to survey Phrases

Phrase number	Phrase	Arithmetic mean	Standard deviation	degree
10	Total quality system contributes to minimising errors in work	2.65	0.72	High
12	Training faculty members and workers on the concepts and requirements of applying the quality management system	2.62	0.97	High
6	The school uses information technology in its various educational processes to achieve quality	2.57	0.61	High

11	The school administration spreads the culture of quality among teachers and workers	2.52	0.62	High
5	The school administration encourages all employees to continuously improve their performance	2.47	0.59	High
18	Reliance on modern technologies in organising and controlling school documents	2.40	0.60	High
20	The school administration focuses on correcting weaknesses and strengthening strengths	1.87	0.60	Medium
1	The school administration provides training programmes for the teaching staff in order to apply quality in the institution	1.87	0.55	Medium
3	-To ensure that teachers are guided to the latest methods used in data collection	1.85	0.59	Medium
2	-Different teaching methods and modern techniques are used to communicate information to the student	1.82	0.31	Medium
21	-Interest in strategic rather than traditional planning	1.81	0.27	Medium
14	-The principal follows up on the academic achievement of students in order to continuously improve school results	1.80	0.36	Medium
8	-Ensuring a comfortable learning environment in the school increases the performance of the staff's performance	1.80	0.40	Medium
4	-The principal is keen to assist teachers in evaluating educational activities	1.77	0.55	Medium
9	The school provides various electronic services for students	1.70	0.50	Medium
7	The school administration encourages the establishment of classroom and extracurricular activities for students	1.63	0.56	Weak

22	Time management and control among administrative staff	1.59	0.65	Weak
13	The principal encourages teachers to train and improve the level	1.55	0.54	Weak
19	Teachers are urged to use constructive dialogue in education	1.52	0.31	Weak
16	Work with students in keeping the school environment clean	1.50	0.40	Weak
17	The school organises regular seminars and meetings aimed at discussing raising the teaching skills of teachers	1.55	0.27	Weak
Total		1.72	0.49	Medium

Source: output spss

Table (6) shows the arithmetic means and standard deviations of the degree of response of the sample members to the paragraphs of the questionnaire, where it is clear that the paragraphs (10-12-6-11-5-18) ranked first with a high score, arithmetic mean (2.65-2.40) and standard deviation (0.72-0.60), which indicates that the total quality system contributes to reducing errors in work and training faculty members and workers on the concepts and requirements of applying the quality management system is among the needs, and the school administration spreads the culture of quality among teachers and workers by encouraging all workers to continuously improve their performance by relying on modern technologies in organising and controlling school documents, while paragraphs (20-1-3-2-21-14-8-4-9) with close arithmetic averages have a medium standard degree and are in the order (1.98-1.93). 98- 1.98-1.93-1.91-1.89-1.87-1.87-1.85-1.82-1.81-1.80-1.80-1.77-1.70) Which indicates that the school administration works to improve decisions in the educational field to achieve the best results and the use of information technology in various educational

processes to achieve quality by spreading the culture of quality among teachers and workers and encouraging them, as well as attention to strategic planning instead of traditional, in addition to providing a comfortable educational environment in the school increases the performance of the effectiveness of the performance of workers by providing various electronic services to students and relying on modern technologies in the

organisation and control of school documents and the interest of the school administration to train the teaching staff to apply quality in the institution and the extent of the application of total quality standards. Therefore, it can be said that the application of total quality standards in primary schools came to a moderate degree as the arithmetic mean of the total questionnaire paragraphs (1.72) and the standard deviation (0.49), so the hypothesis that states that total quality standards are applied in primary schools to a high degree was not fulfilled,

9.2. Presentation and discussion of the results of the second hypothesis: 'There are statistically significant differences in the perception of school principals of the application of quality standards in school administration due to the gender variable'. To answer the hypothesis, an independent t-test was calculated for two independent groups as shown in Table 7.

Gender	Sample	Mean Arithmetic	Deviation Standard	value (t)	Degree of freedom	Level Significance (0.05)	Indication Differences
Males	40	45,77	8,07	1.67	58	0,756	Not statistically significant
Females	20	42,32	5,68				

Source: output spss

Table (7) shows that the value of (T) reached (1.67) at a degree of freedom (59) and a significance level (0.756), indicating that there are no statistically significant differences at a significance level (0.05) between the responses of primary school principals according to their gender (male-female) in terms of their views on the application of quality standards in school management. This means that, in the view of both males and females, all schools face the same weakness in their application of education quality standards, which led them all to agree on this without difference. This is due to the fact that schools are located in the same geographical and social environment, the impact of which was clear to everyone.

9.3.Presentation of the results of the third hypothesis:It states that there are statistically significant differences in the perception of primary school principals of the reality and obstacles to the application of quality standards in school administration due to the variable of professional seniority.

To answer this question, an independent t-test was applied for two independent groups as shown in Table 5

primary school principals in Saida was moderate, which is consistent with the findings of some previous studies such as Fedgouch (2018), Hamouda (2008), and Derbes (1994).

Table 8 shows the results of the t-test for testing the differences between the two groups

Gender	Sample	Average Arithmetic	Deviation Standard	value (t)	Degree of freedom	Level Significance (0.05)	Indication Differences
0 to 10 years	30	12.05	9,07	-1,34	59	0.02	Statistically significant
11 years and above	30	8.22	4,68				

Statistically significant at the 0.05 significance level

Table (8) shows that the significance level (0.02) is lower than the significance level (0.05). Therefore, we conclude that there are statistically significant differences from the perspective of primary school principals regarding the application of quality standards in school management, which can be attributed to the variable of years of experience. In other words, the experience variable has an impact on primary school principals' views of the requirements for applying comprehensive quality standards in school management in favour of school principals with less than five years of professional experience.

9.4.Presentation and discussion of the results of the fourth hypothesis:There are the obstacles to implementing the Total Quality Standards in primary schools from point of view of school principals

To answer the hypothesis, the arithmetic means and standard deviations of the sample individuals' responses to the paragraphs containing obstacles were calculated, as shown in Table 9

Table 9 shows the arithmetic means and standard deviations of the sample's responses to the questionnaire items concerning obstacles

Number Paragraph	Paragraph	Average Arithmetic	deviation Standard	Degree
8	Lack of material resources, raw materials and financial resources necessary to implement comprehensive quality standards at the primary school level.	2,50	0.36	High
15	Lack of suitable premises and a stimulating educational environment for implementing the necessary development activities.	2,49	0.40	High
13	Lack of training courses for primary school headteachers on how to implement quality standards.	2,44	0.55	High
12	Primary school headteachers lack sufficient knowledge of the principles and standards of total quality management.	2,42	0.50	High
5	The current management style of schools by municipalities hinders the implementation of the quality system in primary schools	2,41	0.56	High
10	Overcrowded classrooms and a shortage of educational units hinder the implementation of the total quality system	2,38	0.31	High
17	Principals' lack of control over the use of modern technologies in school management	2,35	0.27	High
16	Principals' lack of conviction regarding the importance of implementing comprehensive quality management	2,81	0.36	High
4	Lack of specialised work teams striving to achieve quality objectives	1,79	0.54	High
1	Principals' adherence to old methods of decision-making and management	1,78	0.31	High
6	Lack of incentives for principals to participate effectively in quality programmes	1,77	0.40	High
11	Absence of continuous planning to improve administrative processes in the institution	1,75	0.27	High
14	Lack of authority granted by management to managers to perform their duties at the primary school level	1,72	0.54	High
18	Weak organisational structure of the institution and its impact on the implementation of quality standards	1,69	0.31	High
7	Weak assessment methods and lack of future quality planning	1,68	0.40	Medium

9	Lack of educational, health and security services in school buildings and facilities	1,68	0.59	Medium
3	Failure to provide schools with sufficient equipment and tools to meet their various needs at the departmental level	1,67	0.60	Medium
2	Lack of clarity regarding quality in the directives and difficulty in developing clear future plans	1,67	0.60	Medium
Total		2.05	0.45	High

Table (9) shows that the overall average of the items included in the obstacles to implementing a comprehensive quality system in primary schools, from the perspective of principals, reached a value of (2.05) with a standard deviation of (0.45), which is a high value, with items (8-15-13-12-5-10-17-16-4-1-6-11-14-18) the highest value in terms of the responses of the sample individuals. From the perspective of primary school principals, the obstacles that limit the implementation of the quality system in primary schools are the lack of material resources, raw materials and financial resources necessary to implement comprehensive quality standards at the primary school level, the lack of suitable premises and a stimulating educational environment for implementing the necessary development activities, the absence of training courses for primary school principals on how to implement quality standards, the lack of sufficient knowledge among primary school principals of the principles and standards of comprehensive quality management, and the current management style of schools by municipalities hinders the implementation of the quality system in primary schools, according to school principals. Overcrowded classrooms and a shortage of educational units also hinder the implementation of the total quality system, as does the lack of control by principals

over the use of modern technologies in school management. Furthermore, principals are not convinced of the importance of implementing total quality management, and there is a lack of specialised work teams seeking to achieve quality objectives, as well as the use of old methods in decision-making and management, and the lack of incentives for managers to participate effectively in quality programmes. Added to this is the absence of continuous planning to improve administrative processes in the institution, the lack of powers granted by the administration to managers to perform their duties at the primary school level, and the weakness of the institution's organisational structure and its impact on the implementation of quality standards. As for the remaining paragraphs (7-9-3-2), the study sample's assessments of them were average.

10. Discuss the results:

The results shown in Table No. (4), which showed that the application of comprehensive quality standards in primary schools was moderate despite the desire of primary school principals to apply comprehensive quality standards in educational institutions by working to spread a culture of quality among teachers and workers and encouraging them to do so, as well as focusing on strategic planning rather than traditional planning, while ensuring a comfortable learning environment in schools, which would increase the performance of employees by providing various electronic services to pupils using modern technologies to organise and control school documents, and the school administration's focus on training teaching staff to apply quality

standards in the institution. Despite all these efforts, it can be said that the application of comprehensive quality standards in school management by primary school principals in the state of Saida was moderate, which is consistent with what has been indicated in some previous studies, including the study by Fadgoush (2018), the study by Hamouda (2008), and the study by Darbas (1994)

There are also no differences between males and females in their view of reality and the obstacles to applying quality standards in school management. The researcher attributes this to the fact that there is a reasonable trend towards applying the principles of total quality management, with the aim of keeping school principals up to date with new methods and trends in school management, rather than relying on traditional methods in the administrative process. as 'current educational organisations with their traditional structures are characterised by fragmentation and a lack or weakness of effectiveness, with rapid change and the movement of societies towards modernisation and development' (Eid, 1995, p. 18). This indicates the conviction of principals that school management keeps pace with social and economic developments. This is in line with the studies by Rami (2018), Al-Sharqawi (2002), and Hamouda (2008)

While the study pointed to differences among the study sample members attributable to the variable of professional experience in favour of primary school principals with less than six years of professional experience, The researcher attributes this to the fact that new and experienced principals do not have the

same perception of the inadequacy of the application of total quality management in school administration, as new principals are aware of the importance of applying total quality standards as a result of training courses. The current result is consistent with the results of Saqr's study (2013), which found differences in the arithmetic means of the degree of application of total quality management standards depending on the variable of years of experience, and Fatima Abu Abdo's study (2011), which found statistically significant differences in the degree of application of total quality standards in schools in the Nablus governorate from the perspective of principals, attributable to the variable of years of experience and in favour of the category with less than 5 years of experience. where the desire of new primary school principals to innovate and prove their professional and administrative competence and keep up with everything new in school management stands out compared to principals with more than 11 years of professional experience. Here, the difference between new and old principals in their pursuit of applying quality standards in school management becomes apparent. The results of the study are consistent with those of Al-Saoud (2003), Daifallah (2017), and Fadgoush (2018)

The results of the study showed that one of the main obstacles to implementing a quality system in primary schools is the lack of material resources, raw materials and financial resources needed to apply comprehensive quality standards at the primary school level, the lack of suitable premises and a stimulating educational environment for implementing the necessary development activities, the

absence of training courses for primary school principals on how to implement quality standards, the lack of sufficient knowledge among primary school principals of the principles of total quality management, the underuse of modern technologies in school management, and their lack of awareness of the importance of implementing total quality management, and the lack of specialised work teams seeking to achieve quality objectives. In addition, the use of old methods by principals in decision-making and management, and the lack of incentives for principals to participate effectively in quality programmes, add to the absence of continuous planning to improve administrative processes in the institution and the lack of authority granted by management to managers to perform their duties at the primary school level were the most prominent obstacles, in their view, to the implementation of quality standards.

11. Conclusion:

Quality in education and its development is currently one of the most important issues occupying modern educational thought, as efforts are directed towards planned change in order to bring about real, meaningful development. Modern societies are introducing the latest curricula and methods in order to guide the process of educational development towards bringing about and achieving development in general.

Our current era is also characterised by comprehensive quality that touches on all variables in order to face challenges and keep pace with them in harmony with good management and facilitation of the education process as one of the institutions of society that is concerned with the

concept of comprehensive quality and seeks to revive and develop it in all aspects of the educational process without exception. Comprehensive quality in education is one of the requirements that societies seek today. It is considered one of the most important and successful means and methods for developing and improving the educational system environment with its material and human components. Indeed, it has become an urgent necessity and a strategic choice dictated by the nature of educational and pedagogical movements at present. The quality of education is achieved through a clear and specific policy for comprehensive quality, efficient administrative organisation of educational institutions, the implementation of a monitoring and evaluation system to avoid mistakes, and the provision of high-level training systems for the educational and administrative staff. As an educational and social institution established by society to serve its purposes and strive to achieve its goals, the school has a duty to contribute to the creation of a scientifically educated generation. It also has a prominent role in working tirelessly to provide the various conditions and possibilities necessary for the preparation and upbringing of the generation. The school carries out its tasks based on careful planning, far from randomness and confusion, to achieve the main goals for which it was established, which are to educate the young in a sound and proper manner, governed by a set of regulations and systems and guided by the general goals of society. This requires knowledge of the degree to which quality education is implemented in schools from the perspective of school administrators, in order to identify the strengths and

weaknesses in the implementation of comprehensive quality in schools. The implementation of quality in school management also requires specific goals that the institution seeks to achieve, encouraging employees to perform better by utilising all possible methods and tools to achieve this, in addition to training teachers and employees on how to use quality methods, giving employees confidence and encouraging them to perform their work, and viewing the process of developing and improving quality as a continuous process.

The study concluded that the level of application of total quality management principles in primary schools in the state of Saida, from the perspective of principals, was moderate, which means that efforts must be made to raise this level by holding training courses in total quality management so that it is easier to apply and implement and clear to all parties in the school.

The results of the study also showed that there were no statistically significant differences between the members of the study sample according to the variable. The results of the study also indicated that those with the longest experience were the least responsive to the application of total quality management principles in primary schools in the state of Saida. Therefore, we propose the following recommendations:

- Hold training courses and activate the monitoring, evaluation and field follow-up system
- Support the dissemination of a culture of total quality in primary schools by introducing its technical methods, stages of implementation, and elements of success

within the framework of a phased plan over a specific period of time

-Focus on developing teachers' skills and abilities through ambitious programmes that work to raise the efficiency and performance of teachers to achieve total quality objectives.

-Work to improve teaching methods and techniques, and use modern technologies and adapt them to serve the educational process and achieve total quality management standards.

-Provide financial resources to achieve total quality management specifications and standards

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